

Lecture 3

Website content writing and Blogging for Business



Website content writing

- Website content writing involves creating **informative, engaging, and SEO-optimized** content for websites to enhance user experience and search engine ranking.
- **Key Elements:**
 - Communicates a brand's message
 - Informs and engages website visitors
 - Encourages user action (buy, subscribe, inquire)
 - Improves visibility on search engines

Homepage Content Writing Best Practices

- **Share your story:** build trust by showcasing your mission, vision and values in relatable way
- **Clear & Concise Message:** Who you are and what you offer.
- **Strong Headline:** Simple, engaging, and problem-solving.
- **Call-to-Action (CTA):** E.g., *“Start Your Free Trial”* or *“Learn More”*.
- **Trust Elements:** Testimonials, case studies, or certifications.
- **What to Include:**
 - **Who you are:** Your brand’s story and purpose.
 - **What you do:** The services/products you offer.
 - **Why you exist:** Your unique value proposition.
 - **Team & Culture:** Show authenticity with images.



WE SERVE ATHLETES*

**If you have a body, you are an athlete*



Photo Essay

The Spaces Where Nike Creates the Future of Sport

Get a behind-the-scenes look at Nike's World Headquarters and the places where we innovate, design and dream, all to serve athletes.



BE GOOD WITH YOUR MONEY SO YOU CAN BE EXPRESSIVE WITH YOUR SPACE

Get your totally free credit score and start making the dream a reality.

[SIGN UP FREE](#)

Bills? Paid

Don't miss a bill again. See and pay your bills in one place.



All-in-one? Done

From money and budgeting to customized tips and more—get a clear view of your total financial life.



Credit? Checked

Find out yours and learn how you can improve it. It's totally free.



Dropbox

Get to work, with a lot less work

Dropbox delivers tools that help you move your work forward faster, keep it safe, and let you collaborate with ease.

[Sign up free](#) →

[Find your plan](#) →

No credit card required.

How to Write Effective Service/Product Pages

- **Showcase your value**
- Clearly explain **what you offer**, how it solves customer problems, and why they should choose you
- **Compelling Headline** (e.g., "Supercharge Your Business with AI-Powered Tools").
- **Benefits Over Features:** Explain how it solves customer pain points.
- **Social Proof:** Testimonials, case studies, and reviews.
- **Call-to-Action (CTA):** *"Start Now", "Book a Demo"*.

Blogging for Business

- Blogging is no longer optional for businesses—it's a necessity. It's a **cost-effective way** to connect with your audience, improve your **online presence**, and **drive growth**.
- By investing time and effort into creating valuable content, you can turn your blog into a powerful business tool.
- In today's hyper-digital world, **getting noticed** for your passion or building your venture requires you to have an active online presence. And a blog is one of the best ways to do that.
- Blogging ensures that your ideas and opinions **gain visibility** on search engines and that your target audience can find you.



Brainstorming blog post ideas

- In this section, you learn which tools are available to you while you're brainstorming.

Get inspiration from your customer avatar

- The **customer avatar process** gives you an **abundant source of information** for brainstorming blog post ideas for your blog. What blog posts, videos, podcasts, and so on should you create to attract and convert your avatar?
- Start by looking at the five components of your avatar:

Goals and values: What is the avatar trying to achieve? What values does he hold dear?

Sources of information: What books, magazines, blogs, and other publications does the avatar reference for information?

Demographics: What is the age, gender, and marital status of the avatar?

Challenges and pain points: What holds the avatar back from achieving her goals?

Objections: Why might the avatar choose not to buy your product or service?

- **Answer each of those questions about your avatar** and use those answers to brainstorm ideas for content.
- **Use the information you know about your target market to create content** that solves your avatar's problem, enters the conversations she's having, speaks to her goals, and meets her objections head-on.

Why Blogging Matters in Business

- **Boosts SEO:** Search engines love fresh, relevant content. Blogging helps improve your website's ranking, making it easier for customers to find you.
- **Builds Trust and Authority:** Sharing valuable insights positions your business as an expert in your field.
- **Drives Traffic:** Blogs attract visitors to your website, increasing the chances of converting them into customers.
- **Engages Your Audience:** Blogs provide a platform to interact with your audience through comments, shares, and feedback.
- **Supports Social Media:** Blog content can be repurposed for social media, email campaigns, and other marketing channels.

A Clearly Defined Target Audience

Choosing a topic with your target audience in mind is one of the hallmarks of a good blog post, and it begins before you put a single word on the page.

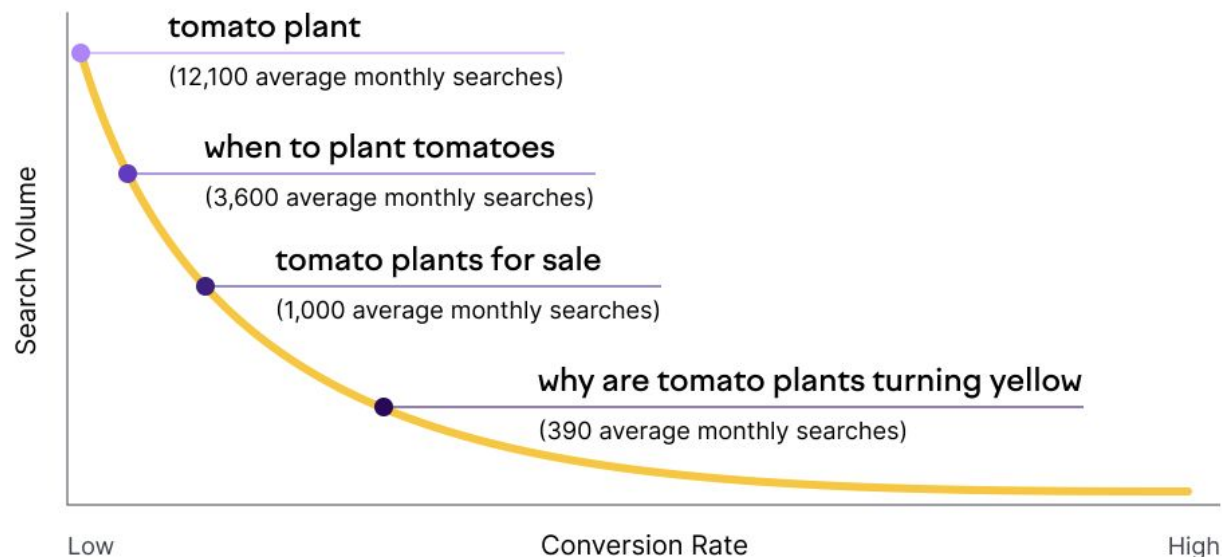
Audience research question checklist

- ✓ What **age group** is your audience?
- ✓ What is their **income bracket**?
- ✓ What do they like to do in their **free time**?
- ✓ Where are they in their **career** and where do they **want to be**?
- ✓ What do they **love**?
- ✓ What do they **hate**?



Long and short tail keywords

Long Tail Keywords



semrush.com



LONG-TAIL KEYWORDS

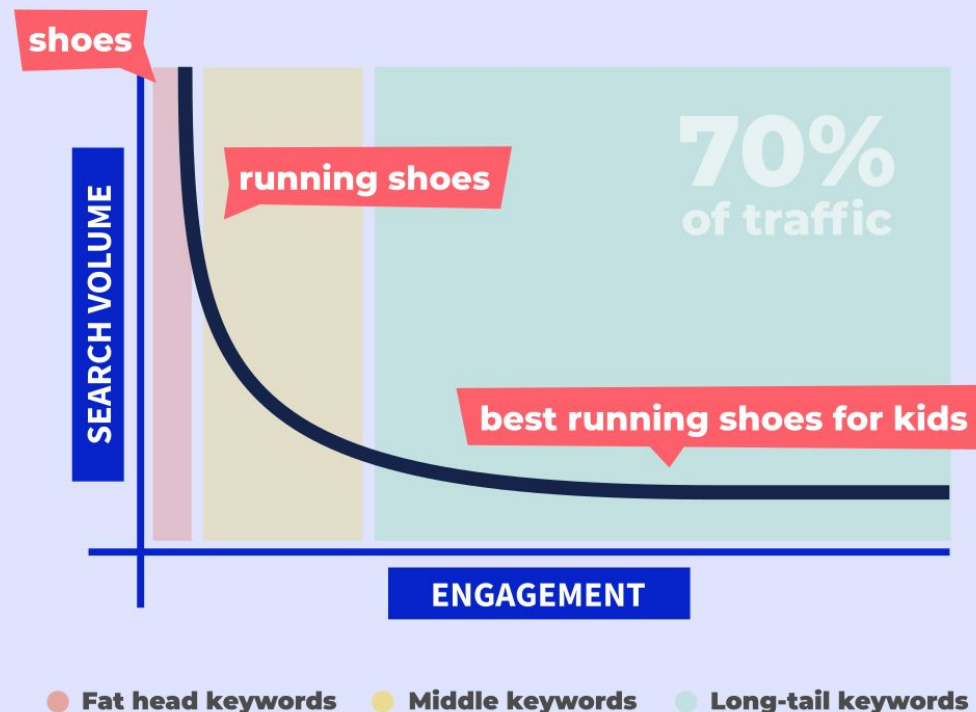


Image by Mangools

Key elements of an impactful blog

- **Target Audience:** Know who you're writing for. What are their pain points, interests, and needs?
- **Quality Content:** Focus on creating informative, engaging, and well-researched posts.
- **Consistency:** Publish regularly to keep your audience engaged and improve SEO.
- **Call-to-Action (CTA):** Encourage readers to take the next step, whether it's subscribing, sharing, or purchasing.
- **Visuals:** Use images, infographics, and videos to make your blog visually appealing.

Compelling Headline

Blog Title Formula: Keyword + Purpose + Value + Action



Keywords

Place important keywords at the beginning of your title so readers and Google know it's relevant.



Purpose

Give context of what the reader can expect. What's the point of your post?



Value

Let readers know what they'll gain from your article. What's in it for them?

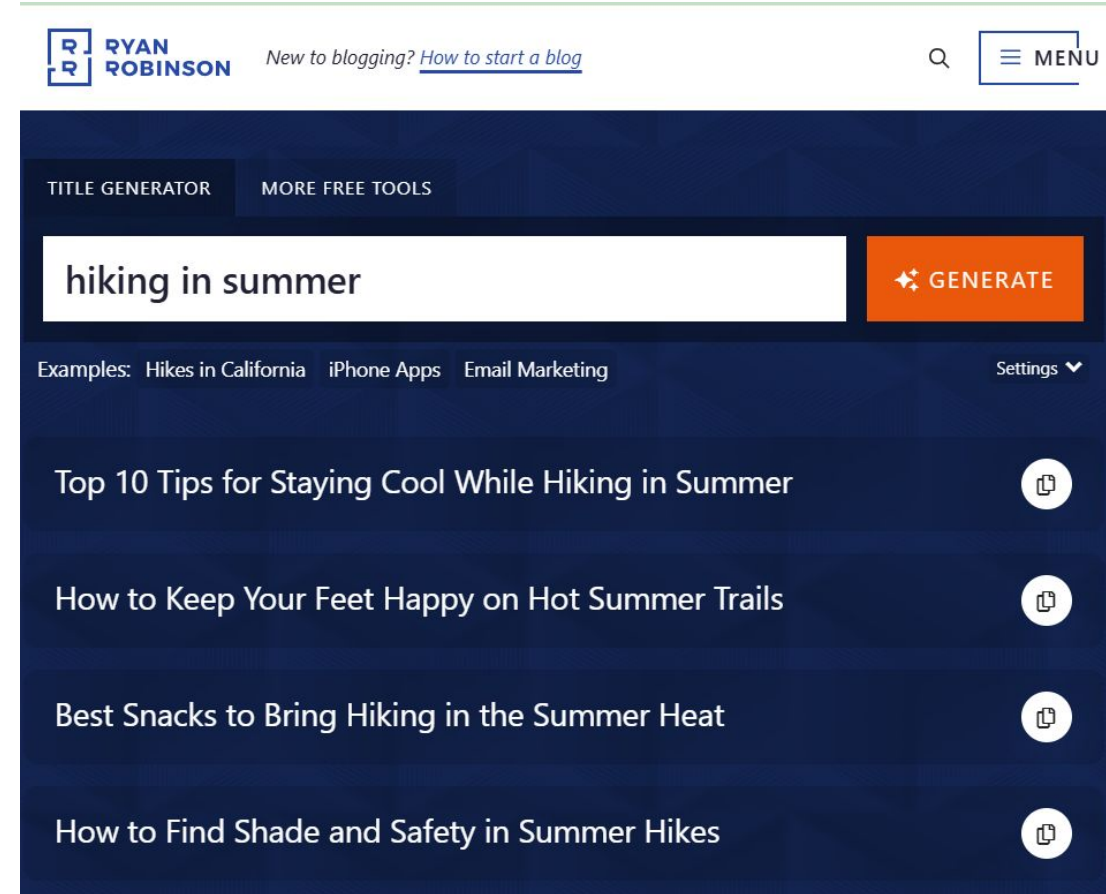


Action

Add a catchy adjective or a call to action to get readers excited about what they'll learn.

Title of the blog

- A great blog title should be attention-grabbing, clear, and optimized for both readers and search engines. Here are the key requirements for crafting an effective title.
- Readers should immediately understand what your blog post is about. Avoid vague or overly clever titles that might confuse them.
- **Example:**
 - Weak: "Ways to Improve Your Business"
 - Strong: "10 Proven Strategies to Boost Your Small Business Revenue in 2024"
- Use tools like Google Keyword Planner, SEMrush, or Ahrefs to identify high-traffic keywords related to your topic.
- **Example:**
 - Weak: "How to Start a Blog"
 - Strong: "How to Start a Successful Blog in 2024: A Step-by-Step Guide"



Skimmable Content

- I've referred to website visitors as "readers" thus far, but "skimmers" is more fitting.
- In a perfect world, readers would read every word you publish, but in reality, most people are skimmers. Keeping your content focused, concise, and easy to follow is what keeps your readers moving down the page.
- Here's how to do it:
 - Keep sentences as short as possible (two lines max).
 - Keep paragraphs short — no more than 4-5 lines per paragraph.
 - Use bulleted lists to break up content (take this one, for example).
 - Add in-post images to keep readers engaged.
 - Speak simply and clearly.
 - Say only what's absolutely necessary to convey your message.

Readers want specific information and they don't want to work to get it. When you structure your posts with this in mind, you create clear value that keeps them coming back for more.

Engaging Visuals

- Humans are visual creatures. Breaking up your post with engaging visual elements can level up your content and make it easier for readers to digest.
- Articles with over seven images see 116% more organic traffic than those with none. Providing something to look at besides text gives readers a refreshing visual break that keeps them engaged for longer.
- Mailchimp does this well on their blog:

1. Choose what kind of loan you want

When you are just starting out, your **business credit** and your personal credit tend to be the same thing—even if you have formed an LLC or a corporation. Lenders make judgments on business loans on the basis of personal credit reports, at least until the business is up and running. But there are certain kinds of financing that you can get even in your startup period.

Types of business loans (and loan terms):

- ✓ Business term loan (1 to 10 years)
- ✓ SBA loan (5 to 25 years)
- ✓ Business line of credit (2 to 10 years)
- ✓ Personal loan (no fixed repayment terms)
- ✓ Merchant cash advance (3 to 18 months)



Strategic Keyword Placement

If you want your blog post to rank, there are a few keyword optimizations to keep in mind.

- Be sure to include your target keyword in the following places:
- Towards the front of your post title
- In your URL structure
- In your meta description
- In image alt text
- Once in your introduction and conclusion

While you should be intentionally using your target keyword and its variants throughout your post, avoid keyword stuffing like the plague.

Which Vacuum Cleaner is best for me?

Which is the **best vacuum cleaner** for you? With so many choices around, deciding for the best model may prove to be a difficult task.

The **most used vacuum** cleaners these days are the **upright and canister** types.

So if you are trying to choose the **best vacuum cleaner** among them, you need to keep a few things in mind.

Call to Action

- The Call to Action (CTA) encourages readers to take further action after reading your blog. Here's how to craft an effective CTA:
- **Be Clear and Direct:** Tell the reader exactly what you want them to do next. Whether it's subscribing, commenting, or exploring more content, make the action clear.
- **Create Urgency or Value:** Offer an incentive or reason for the reader to act now.

Monitor your own data

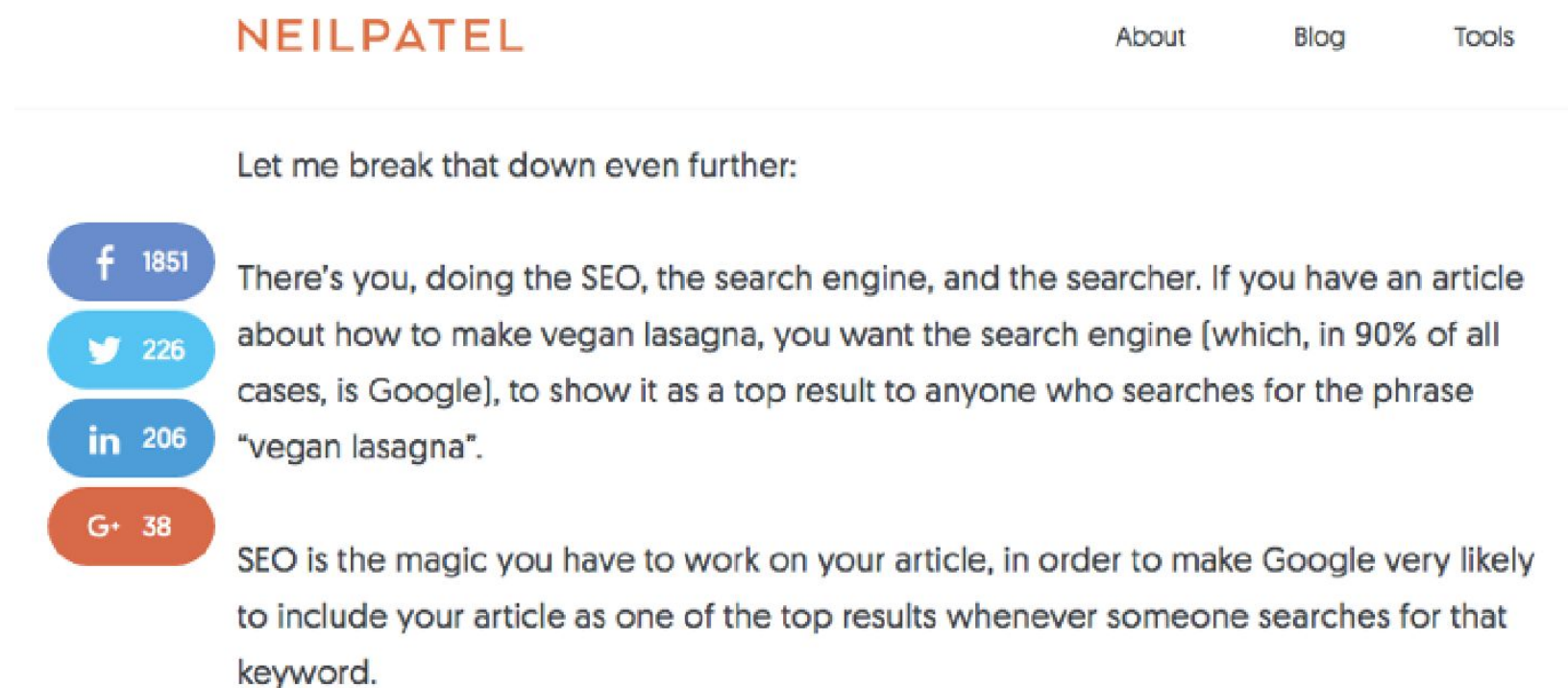
- The **savvy blogger** watches how the audience responds to content by monitoring data points.
- These **data points** help you determine what you should produce more of in the future.
- **Google Analytics** is a free tool that allows you to view data about how your visitors are using your website.
- You can use **Google Analytics to determine** which blog posts on your website receive the most traffic, which posts people spend the most time on, and where the traffic comes from (for example, Twitter, Google, and email).
- You should also **keep an eye on the number of social shares** on each blog post.
- If you use a **content management system** like WordPress or Squarespace, **you can install social sharing buttons** that allow blog visitors to easily share your content with their network on sites like Twitter, Facebook, or Pinterest.
- Engagement Metrics: Monitor comments, shares, and time spent on the page.
- Conversion Rates: Measure how many readers take desired actions (e.g., signing up for a newsletter or making a purchase).
- SEO Performance: Check keyword rankings and organic search traffic.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Ignoring SEO: Failing to optimize for search engines can limit your blog's reach.
- Inconsistent Posting: Irregular updates can lead to a loss of audience interest.
- Over-Promotion: Focus on providing value rather than constantly selling.
- Neglecting Mobile Users: Ensure your blog is mobile-friendly.
- Skipping Proofreading: Typos and errors can harm your credibility.

- **Use information pulled from your internal data sources** such as Google Analytics, keyword trackers, and social media to see how your content is performing.

FIGURE 5-1:
A blog post
from Neil Patel
which received high
social engagement
— as indicated by
the numbers on the
left.



Source:
<https://neilpatel.com/blog/>

FIGURE 5-2:
An excerpt of a
segmented post
from Moz.



By: Rand Fishkin

September 23rd, 2016

How to Appear in Google's Answer Boxes - Whiteboard Friday

[Advanced SEO](#) | [Search Engines](#) | [Whiteboard Friday](#)

The author's views are entirely his or her own (excluding the unlikely event of hypnosis) and may not always reflect the views of Moz.

Featured snippets are the name of the rankings game. Often eclipsing organic results at the top of the SERPs, "ranking zero" or capturing an answer box in Google can mean increased clicks and traffic to your site. In today's Whiteboard Friday, Rand explains the three types of featured snippets and

 71

 68

Source:

<https://moz.com/blog/how-to-appear-in-googles-answer-boxes-whiteboard-friday>

Working with content creators

- To produce the content necessary to grow your blog, you're likely to need a team of writers.
- An outside writer is someone not associated with your brand who creates content assets for your blog.
- Those content assets are typically written articles, but the content can also take the form of audio, video, and images for your blog.
- Acquiring quality outside content creators gives your blog a broad range of perspectives and can help give authority and reach to your blog.
- This is especially true if the content creator is an *influencer*, that is, someone who has an above average impact in his or her niche.
- Influencers often have a following of their own and are connected to key players in media outlets, consumer groups, or industry associations.

Applying Blog Headline Formulas

- The headline is the most important part of your post **because it cuts through the noise to grab your readers' attention** and convince them to give you their precious time by reading your article.
- But how do you come up with these stellar blog headlines that increase clicks? You **follow a formula**.
- There are **different categories that great blog headlines fall into**, and we're going to detail each.

1. How-to

4. Ultimate guide

7. Opinion

2. Listicle

5. Case study

8. Comparison

3. Question

6. Interview

9. Beginner's guide



Tapping into self-interest

- Self-interest headlines **are usually direct and speak to a specific benefit that your audience will gain** by reading your blog post.
- These **headlines start to answer the “What’s in it for me?” question**, as well as help prequalify readers by giving them a clue about what the article entails.

Here are some **sample self-interest headlines**:

- Grow Your Website Traffic with the 3-Step Content Marketing Plan
- How to Retire in Style Even if You Haven’t Started Saving
- Top 10 Organic Food Markets in Austin, Texas

Piquing curiosity

- These headlines **pique the interest of readers without giving away too much information**, which leads to a higher number of clicks.
- In curiosity headlines **readers have a hard time resisting reading the blog post**.
- **Be careful**, though, because curiosity-based headlines can fall flat if you miss the mark. Because curiosity headlines are more ambiguous, **you might annoy your reader when the content fails to live up to the expectations**.
- So, make sure that your curiosity headline doesn't mislead your reader.

Here are some examples of curiosity headlines:

- 25 Things You Didn't Know Your iPhone Could Do
- Grill the Perfect Beef Filet with the “Butterfly Process”
- This is Why You Should Never Drink Raw Milk

Employing urgency and scarcity

- The **most powerful way to get someone to read your blog post is to impart urgency or scarcity** with your headline.
- Headlines that communicate **urgency and scarcity** tell readers they must act *now*, or they'll miss **something**.
- **Use urgency and scarcity headlines only when you truly have a deadline**, limited quantity, or limited availability.
- Here are some urgency and scarcity headlines:
 - Get Tickets Now! Woody Allen Speaking at Lincoln Center on October 15th
 - Free Photography Classes: Last Chance for Open Enrollment
 - New Book Reveals Ancient Weight Loss Secret; Supplies are Limited

Issuing a warning

- Often, **people will be more motivated to take action to avoid pain than gain a benefit**.
- Well-crafted warning headlines, like the following, **incorporate the promise that you can protect yourself from a threat** if you take action:
 - The Big Lie Hiding in Your Apartment Rental Contract
 - Warning: Don't Buy Another Ounce of Dog Food Until You Read This
 - Is Your Child's Mattress Harmful to His or Her Health?

Auditing a Blog Post

- When you're reading or editing a blog post, **putting your finger on the *specific* reasons a post is falling short of fabulous** can be difficult.
- Communicating what needs to be improved to a writer or content team can be even more difficult — that is, **these things are difficult if you don't have a process or don't know what to look for.**
- **To audit your blog post, you should examine ten elements.**
- The following sections discuss each element to help you learn to evaluate and improve each one.

FIGURE 5-4:

A blog post uses formatting in a way that makes the content easy to consume.

Social Media Marketing

189 Powerful Words That Convert: Write Copy That Gets Your Customer's Attention Every Time



by Kevan Lee



"Join us!"

Source:

<https://buffer.com/library/words-and-phrases-that-convert-ultimate>

Satisfies your goal

- Although a blog has many goals, such as branding, providing your audience value, and establishing yourself as an authority, the **main goal of a blog is to generate quality leads that ultimately lead to sales**. The **keys to higher conversion rates from blog content** are as follows:

Relevance: The **offer you make in the post needs to relate to that article's topic**. The more congruent the offer, the more likely you'll secure a conversion.

Consumption: If the copy is **difficult to get through**, readers will leave your page in frustration.

- To help meet the goal, be sure to include the following in each article that you publish:
 - A clear call to action (CTA) **that is relevant to the subject matter of the article**.
 - **Effective copy and design** for the call to action so that it compels readers to take the desired action.
 - A **call to action that is located in one or more prominent positions within the post**, giving it a better chance of being seen.
- Figure 5-5 shows a call to action from DigitalMarketer blog, catching visitors' attention before visitors leave the site.
- This CTA has a simple message and design that helps to grab attention and generate clicks.

the opportunity to segment your unengaged list and put them through a re-engagement campaign.

You want to take your subscribers and move them into the Conversion Stage of the **Customer Value Journey**—and that can't be done if they never get your emails. If your subscribers don't get your emails, they'll never know about your offers, products, or content.

That's why email deliverability is a huge part of **every email marketing strategy**.

A promotional banner with a blue background. At the top, a black bar contains a countdown timer: 02 DAYS, 09 HOURS, 10 MINUTES, and 07 SECONDS. Below this, a white pill-shaped button reads "LIMITED TIME ONLY". The main text in white, bold, sans-serif font says "SAVE UP TO 80% ON OUR BEST-SELLING PRODUCTS!". At the bottom, a green button with white text says "CHECK OUT THE DEALS »".

f Share

6

6 SHARES

lab

FIGURE 5-5:
A DigitalMarketer
blog post with
a scarcity
countdown
CTA.

Source:

<https://www.digitalmarketer.com/blog/what-is-email-delive>

Includes quality media

- The images, videos, and audio files that you include in an article make up the media of your post.
- Quality **media that loads quickly is extremely important** to the success of an article.
- **Media that takes longer than three seconds to load, or is of poor quality**, causes readers to become frustrated and seek out blog content that doesn't make them wait or that looks fuzzy.
- Committing to the production of high-quality media is one way to stand out in an industry saturated with content.
- Therefore, **be sure to include high-quality images, videos, and audio that are clean and crisp**. Also, look for instances where media can further explain or enrich a point made in an article.
- Hiring a full-time photographer or graphic designer may not be necessary but **try to avoid using stock images and video**.
- Often, stock forms of media look too staged or forced, plus they don't always match well with the topic of your piece.

Provides a compelling close

- Your article's closing paragraph can take your post from good to great. Effective conclusions tie the piece together.
- Therefore, by the close, any curiosity loops that your heading may have opened need to be answered, and you must have delivered on the promise of the article; otherwise, readers feel cheated and might form a negative impression of your brand.
- You can **finish a post by using humor, wit, or insight, or otherwise incite emotions that compel readers to comment, share, or visit more pages on your blog**.

Uses search engine optimization

- Done right, **effective search engine optimization (SEO) helps your blog posts rank higher in search engines**, such as Google, which will improve your chances of having your blog posts found by your audience.
- To optimize your blog post, choose a relevant keyword or keyword phrase that is unique to your post and include that keyword in the
 - Title tag
 - Body text
 - Image alt attribute
 - Universal resource locator (URL)
 - Meta description
- Another important way to optimize your blog is to **cross-link related and relevant sites to your blog article**.
- You can link to other sites that aren't associated with your brand but are relevant to the topic of the article.
- You can also cross-link to other blog posts you've written that elaborate on or enrich a point that you make in your latest post.

Categorizes your topics

- As your blog expands, you may find yourself covering a larger base of topics.
- This is where categorizing and organizing your blogs posts comes into play.
- **For instance, an economics blog may cover a wide variety of topics, such as tax tips, financial planning, budget and saving, and others.**
- To help readers find what they are looking for, include categories, also called tags, on each post you publish.
- Including categories helps to improve user experience, which in turn increases the value that you bring to your audience.
- Although it's often as simple as selecting a box by using your mouse, selecting the right category for your blog posts is an important checkpoint of any blog post audit.

Keeps professional consistency

- What's the voice or personality of your brand? Is it professional? Academic?
- Whatever it may be, produce content that reinforces your brand. For instance, a law firm blog probably shouldn't use curse words in its articles.
- But an edgy motorcycle blog has a better chance of getting away with using certain four-letter words because doing so might be more consistent with its brand.
- Therefore, **whatever the topic of your article, be sure that it remains in line with your brand's personality.**
- Also, and perhaps more important for some organizations, **ensure that the newest blog post doesn't contradict something else that you've published on the blog or anywhere else.**
- For example, if you have a fashion blog with a post last year about the sins of wearing undershirts, but your newest blog post centers on the importance of undershirts and doesn't address what has changed since your past article on the topic, you're going to confuse and lose readers because of your inconsistency.